

# Concrete Visions: The Legacy of Brutalism in Urban Landscapes

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# What is Brutalism?

- Emerged in the mid-20th century
- Derived from *béton brut* (raw concrete)
- Focus on functionality and material honesty
- Strong geometric forms and monumental scale

# Impact on Urban Landscapes

- Widely used in public housing and civic buildings
- Emphasis on social purpose and accessibility
- Criticized for perceived coldness and austerity
- Iconic examples remain influential today

# Legacy and Reinterpretation

- Renewed interest among contemporary architects
- Preservation vs. demolition debates
- Influence on minimalism and modern urban design
- Brutalism as both cultural artifact and inspiration